



DICTIONARY
OF THE
LANGUAGE OF FLOWERS



Abruptness, *Borage.*

Absence, *Wormwood.*

Accommodating disposition, *Valerian.*

Activity, *Thyme*. See p. 34.

A friend in adversity, *Snowdrop*. See p. 86.

Afterthought, *Large-flowered Aster*.

The large-flowered aster begins to bloom when other flowers become scarce. It is, as it were, the afterthought of Flora, who smiles while leaving us.

Agitation, *Rhododendron*.

Honey made from the flowers of the rhododendron was anciently supposed to cause delirium, and very probably some of the species possess poisonous qualities. Undoubtedly this is the most brilliant of all American shrubs. The less showy but beautiful azaleas belong to this family.

Always cheerful, *Coreopsis*.

Always remembered, *Everlasting*.

Ambition, *Hollyhock*.

Amiability, *Jasmine*. See p. 48.

Anger, *Gorse*, or *Furze*.

The furze blossom resembles the broom, but the plant is very prickly. It grows in greater profusion in England than in any other country. It is said that Linnæus, when he saw it for the first time, near London, fell on his knees enraptured; and, carrying some plants to Sweden, tried to raise them in a hot-house. Virgil mentions the furze. Keats speaks of

“downs, where sweet air stirs
Blue harebells lightly, and where prickly furze
Buds lavish gold.”

“Here the furze,
Enriched among its spires with golden flowers,
Scents the keen air.”

Charlotte Smith.

Animosity, *St. John's Wort*.

“ Hypericum beneath each sheltering bush
Its healing virtue modestly conceals.”

Dodsley.

Artifice, *Clematis*.

To excite commiseration, beggars sometimes produce on themselves, by applying the juice of the clematis, factitious sores. This infamous artifice sometimes results in real ulcers.

Arts, *Acanthus*. See p. 25.

Asylum, *Aid*, *Juniper*. See p. 87.

Audacity, *Larch*.

Austerity, *Thistle*.



Beauty ever new, *Monthly Rose*.

Be my support, *Black Bryony*.

Beloved daughter, *Cinquefoil*.

Beneficence, *Marshmallow*. See p. 51.

Benevolence, Potato.

The reader is referred to Humboldt for the history of the potato. In England, in the reign of James I., it was considered a great delicacy, and provided only in very small quantities for the queen's household. Bradley, an extensive writer on horticultural subjects at the beginning of the eighteenth century, says of potatoes, "They are of less note than horseradish, radish, scorzonera, beets, and skirret; but as they are not without their admirers, I will not pass them by in silence." It was unknown in Saxony as late as 1740, but cultivated earlier in Switzerland.

Parmentier, by the most persevering labors, succeeded in introducing the cultivation of this useful vegetable into France, in the reign of Louis XVI. It had been known in Italy long before.

Benevolence, Hyacinth.

The poets are not agreed whether the hyacinth sprung from the blood of Ajax or that of Hyacinthus; but the flower they so designate was probably a kind of lily, and not our modern hyacinth. This, however, does not lack praise.

Hyacinths, with their graceful bells,
Where the spirit of odor dwells."

Miss Landon.

"The hyacinth, purple, white, and blue,
Which flung from its bells a sweet peal anew
Of music so delicate, soft, and intense,
It was felt like an odor within the sense."

Shelley.

"Shaded hyacinth, alway
Sapphire queen of the mid-May."

Keats.

In the bower of Eve,—

"hyacinth, with rich inlay,
Broidered the ground, more colored than with stone
Of costliest emblem."

The curling petals furnished Milton with a simile in describing Adam.

“Hyacinthine locks
Round from his parted forelock manly hung
Clustering.”

Collins, too, speaks of

“The youth whose locks divinely spreading
Like vernal hyacinths.”

The poetical Hyacinth of the ancients was supposed to wear

“His bitter sorrows painted on his bosom.”

“As poets feigned, from Ajax’ streaming blood
Arose, with grief inscribed, a mournful flower.”

Young.

“In the flower he weaved
The sad impression of his sighs; which bears
A1 — A1 — displayed in funeral characters.”

Sandys’s Ovid.

“Camus, reverend sir, went footing slow,
His mantle hairy, and his bonnet sedge,
Inwrought with figures dim, and on the edge
Like to that sanguine flower inscribed with woe.”

Milton.

Beware, Oleander.

Birth, Dittany of Crete.

When Juno, under the name of Lucina, presided at the birth of children, she wore a wreath of dittany. Its good odor and medicinal qualities, which caused it to be esteemed by the ancients, make it still valued. It is a native of the isle of Crete.

In Martyn’s Botany we read, “Dittany of Crete has the small purple flowers collected in loose, nodding heads; the stalks are pubescent, purplish, and send out small branches from their sides by pairs; the leaves are round, thick, and so

woolly as to be quite white; the whole plant has a piercing, aromatic scent and biting taste." Woodville, in his Medical Botany, gives a figure of it, and says, "Both the Greek and Roman writers have fabled this plant into great celebrity; of which a single instance, related by the Latin poet, affords a beautiful illustration." See *Æneid* XII. 411-416.

Bitterness, *Aloe*. See p. 84.

Blackness, *Ebony Tree*.

Blemish, *Henbane*.

Boldness, *Larch*.

The larch is often found at a prodigious elevation on mountains.

Bonds of love, *Honeysuckle*. See p. 28.



Calmness, *Buckbean*. See p. 21.

Calumny, *Madder*.

Candor, *White Violet*.

Capricious Beauty, *Musk Rose*.

This capricious rose will languish in situations which at first appeared most favorable to it. One year it will be loaded with flowers, and the next it will refuse to blossom at all.

Chagrin, *Marigold*. See p. 56.**Change**, *Pimpernel*.

Always closing before rain, it denotes a change of weather.

Chastity, *Orange Blossom*.**Coarseness**, **Grossness**, *Pompion*, or *Pumpkin*.**Coldness**, *Agnus Castus*. See p. 84.**Compassion**, *Elder*.

The elder is said to furnish quack doctors with many of their most successful remedies. The great Boerhaave is said to have held the medicinal qualities of the elder in such reverence, that he would take off his hat when passing it. Elder berries make a very excellent wine.

Conceit, *Pomegranate*.

A pomegranate in Spanish is *granada*; and the kingdom of Granada is said to have derived its name from the pomegranate trees planted there by the Moors; which is quite probable, from a cleft pomegranate being represented on its arms.

Confession of love, *Rosebud*. See p. 42.**Confidence**, *Liverwort*.**Conjugal love**. *Linden*, or *Lime*. See p. 33.

Consolation, *Snowdrop. Corn Poppy.*

Cowley says, —

“Indulgent Ceres knew my worth,
And to adorn the teeming earth
She bade the poppy blow.”

Constancy, *Canterbury Bell.*

Coolness, *Lettuce.*

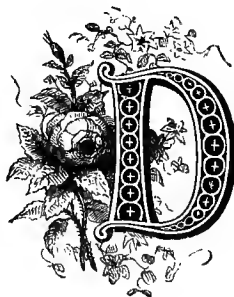
Coquetry, *Morning Glory.* See p. 62.

Courage, *Black Poplar.*

The tree is consecrated to Hercules.

Cruelty, *Nettle.*

The sting of the nettle causes a pain like a burn. The mechanism of the sting is similar to a bee's, as may be seen by looking at a leaf under the microscope.



Deceitful charms, *Datura.* See p. 58.

Declaration of love, *Tulip.* See p. 20.

Dejection, *Lupine*.

“ Tristes lupini.”

Virgil.

A beautiful white lupine is found wild in North America. All the species have rich, velvety leaves, and the variety of color in their flowers is very great.

Delicacy, *Bluebottle*.**Departure, *Sweet Pea*.**

The dark sweet pea is a native of Sicily; and the light, of Ceylon.

“ Here are sweet peas, on tiptoe for a flight,
With wings of gentle flush o’er delicate white,
And taper fingers catching at all things,
To bind them all about with tiny rings.”

Keats.

Desertion, *Anemone* (*Windflower*).

Anemone was a nymph beloved by Zephyr. Flora, jealous, banished her from her court, and metamorphosed her into a flower which always expands before Spring has really returned. Zephyr abandoned this unhappy beauty to the rough caresses of Boreas, who shakes the blossom, rudely opens it, and soon destroys it.

Desire, *Jonquil*.

Thomson speaks of

“ Jonquils of potent fragrance.”

And Bidlake, —

“ The jonquil loads with potent breath the air,
And rich in golden glory nods.”

Prior, too, —

“ The smelling tuberoses and jonquil declare
The stronger impulse of the evening air.”

Of the same family are Shakspeare's daffodils, —

“ That come before the swallow dares, and take
The winds of March with beauty.”

Desire to please, *Mezereon.*

Devotion, *Passion Flower.*

Difficulties, *Black Thorn.*

Discretion, *Maiden Hair.*

Disdain, *Rue.*

“ There's rue for you; and here's some for me: — we may call it herb
of grace o' Sundays: — you may wear your rue with a difference.”

“ Here did she drop a tear; here, in this place,
I'll set a hank of rue, sour herb of grace;
Rue, even for ruth, here shortly shall be seen
In the remembrance of a weeping queen.”

Shakspeare.

Before the Reformation, priests used to sprinkle the people
in church with bunches of rue dipped in the holy water;
hence the name of Herb of Grace o' Sundays.

Disguise, *Thorn Apple.*

Distinction, *Cardinal Flower.*

The cardinal flower, or scarlet lobelia, is one of the most
splendid American flowers. It was introduced into Great
Britain in 1629, and Justice says of it, “ A flower of most
handsome appearance, which should not be wanting in curious
gardens, as it excels all other flowers I ever knew in the rich-
ness of its scarlet color.”

Docility, *Rush.*

Do me justice, *Chestnut.*

Do not abuse me, *Saffron Crocus.*

Duration, Continuance, *Cornelian Cherry.* See p. 76.



Egotism, *Poet's Narcissus.* See p. 32.

Elegance, *Rose Acacia.*

Elevation, *Fir.*

Eloquence, *Water Lily.*

“ Brilliant thyself in store of dazzling white,
 Thy sister plants more gaudy robes unfold :
 This flames in purple ; that, intensely bright
 Amid the illumined waters, burns in gold.

To brave Osiris' fiery beam is thine,
 Till in the distant west his splendors fade ;
 Thou, too, thy beauties and thy fire decline,
 With morn to rise, in lovelier charms arrayed.

Thus from Arabia, borne on golden wings,
 The phoenix on the sun's bright altar dies,
 But from his flaming bed refulgent springs,
 And cleaves with bolder plume the sapphire skies.”

T. Maurice.

The Egyptians consecrated the lotus to the god of eloquence, and it forms part of the head-dress of Osiris. The East Indian gods are often represented in the midst of water

seated on a lotus flower. Perhaps it may be an emblem of the world issuing from the deep.

In Moore's *Lalla Rookh*, we read of

“Those virgin lilies, all the night
 Bathing their beauties in the lake,
 That they may rise more fresh and bright
 When their beloved sun's awake.”

Camdeo, or Cáma, the Indian Cupid, has his nest “in the water lily's breast,” and floats on its leaves.

The true lotus is the red *nymphæa* of Hindustan. The blue lotus, according to Sir William Jones, grows only in Cashmere and Persia. The rose-colored water lilies of Bengal resemble our own white ones, except that they are of larger size.

We give Mr. Caldwell's translation of the pretty lyric of Geibel, “*Die stille Wasser rose*.”

“The quiet water lily
 Floats on the lakelet blue;
 Its soft leaves glow and glisten,
 Its cup of snowy hue.

The fair moon smileth on her,
 Through all the summer night,
 And on her fragrant bosom
 Pours all her golden light.

Over the rippling water
 Glideth a snow-white swan;
 He singeth sweet and softly,
 The lily gazing on.

He singeth sweet and softly;
 Thus will his death-song flow;
 O flower, snow-white flower,
 Dost thou its meaning know?”

Enchantment, Vervain. See p. 50.

Encouragement, *Golden Rod.*

This flower, so common in the autumn, was anciently much valued, and used in medicine. Gerarde says, after alluding to the high price it brought till discovered growing near London, "This verifieth our English proverbe, 'Far fetcht and deere bought is best for the ladies.' Thus much I have spoken to bring these new-fangled fellowes back againe to esteeme better of this admirable plant."

Endurance, *Pine.*

The pine disdains the peaceful quiet of the garden; it loves to bathe its head in the dew of the clouds, and feel its foliage beaten by the winds. Stripped of its branches, it floats on the ocean, to brave the tempests there.

Energy in adversity, *Camomile.*

Camomile grows the more by being trampled on. Its bitter aromatic flowers are well known for their virtues.

"He the root
Of broad angelica, and tufted flower
Of creeping camomile, impregnates deep
With powers carminative."

Dodsley.

Envy, *Briers.***Error, *Bee Orchis.***

This flower bears so striking a resemblance to a honey-bee, as to frequently deceive.

Esteem, *Sage.*

The sage is justly esteemed for its medicinal and culinary virtues. The flowers of some of the species are exceedingly brilliant and beautiful.

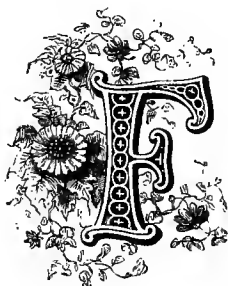
The ancients have left us several proverbs showing their

appreciation of this herb. Among them we find the following:—

“*Salvia cum ruta faciunt tibi pocula tuta.*”

“*Salvia salvatrix, naturæ conciliatrix.*”

“*Cur moriatur homo cui salvia crescit in horto?*
Contra vim mortis non est medicamen in hortis.”



Faith, *Passion Flower.*

The different species of the passion flower are natives of South America. The name was given by the missionaries who first discovered it, as they saw in it the emblems of our Saviour's passion. The ten petals were supposed to indicate the ten faithful apostles; the stamens, a glory; the purple thread around the style, the crown of thorns; the style, the pillar of scourging; the tendrils, the cords; the leaves, the hands; the three divisions of the style, the three nails; one of the five stamens, a hammer; the other four, the cross. The time of three days between its opening and closing,

completed the parallel, in the eyes of the simple and pious fathers.

Falsehood, *Bugloss*. See p. 26.

Falseness, *Manchineel Tree*.

Its fruit looks very good, and, by its agreeable odor, invites one to taste; but its soft, spongy flesh contains a milky, perfidious juice, which is at first insipid, but soon becomes so caustic as to burn the lips, the palate, and the tongue. Travellers say that the best remedy against a poison so violent, is the water of the sea, on whose shores this tree always grows.

False Riches, *Sunflower*. See p. 63.

Fecundity, *Hollyhock*.

The Chinese represent Nature crowned with these flowers. The hollyhock was brought from Syria, in the time of the crusades.

Festivity, *Parsley*. See p. 75.

Fidelity, *Speedwell*, or *Veronica*.

One of the loveliest flowers in all the realm of nature. Tennyson does not forget

“The little speedwell’s darling blue.”

And Dupont, in his charming piece, *La Véronique*, says that it is a dewdrop tinged by reflected light, which Aurora has transformed to a flower. He goes on to say,—

“O fleur insaisissable et pure,
Saphir dont nul ne sait le prix,
Mêlez-vous à la chevelure
De celle dont je suis épris;

Pointillez dans la mousseline
 De son blanc peignoir entr'ouvert,
 Et dans la porcelaine fine
 Où sa lèvre boit le thé vert.

* * *

O véroniques, sous les chênea
 Fleurissez pour les simples cœurs,
 Qui, dans les traverses humaines,
 Vont cherchant les petites fleurs."

Fidelity in misfortune, *Wall Flower*. See p. 64.

Finesse, *Sweet William*.

Fire, *Fraxinella*.

In a warm, dry day, a gas exhales from the fraxinella, which forms an inflammable atmosphere around it, easily ignited by the approach of a lighted candle.

First emotions of love, *Lilac*. See p. 18.

Flame, *German Iris*.

The German peasants sometimes plant this flower on the roofs of their cottages. The sun, gilding the petals as they wave in the breeze, produces a flame-like appearance.

Flattery, *Venus's Looking Glass*.

It is related that Venus dropped one of her mirrors. A shepherd picked it up, and as soon as he looked in it, forgot his mistress, and thought only of admiring himself, for the mirror had the gift of making beautiful all who looked in it. Love, fearing the consequences of such a silly error, broke the toy, and changed its fragments into this pretty campanula, which still retains its name.

Folly, *Columbine*.

Its flowers, resembling a fool's-cap, gave rise to this emblem.



FLORISSED BY DE VRIES, IBARRA ET C^o. BOSTON

Foresight, *Holly*. See p. 82.

Forgetfulness, *Satin Flower*, or *Honesty*

René, Duke of Bar and Lorraine, having been taken prisoner at the battle of Thoulougeau, painted with his own hand a branch of this plant, and sent it to his people to reproach them for their tardiness in delivering him from captivity. It seems to have been used in magical incantations, for we find in Drayton, —

“Enchanting Lunarie here lies,
In sorceries excelling.”

And in Lalla Rookh, Namouna puts in the chaplet of Nourmahal

“the white moon-flower, as it shows,
On Serendib’s high crags, to those
Who near the isle at evening sail.”

Forget me not, *Forget-me-not*. See p. 60.

Forgiveness of injuries, *Cinnamon Tree*.

“The dream of the injured, patient mind,
That smiles with the wrongs of men,
Is found in the bruised and wounded rind
Of the cinnamon, sweetest then.”

Moore.

The cassia of commerce must not be confounded with the cassia which bears a beautiful yellow flower in our green-houses.

Forsaken, *Common Willow*.

Fragility, *Fuchsia*.

Frankness, *Osier*.

Fraternal love, *Syringa*.

A king of Egypt, one of the Ptolemys, was celebrated for

his love to his brother. His surname, Philadelphus (*loving his brother*), was given to this species of syringa, which was consecrated to his memory.

Friendship, Ivy. See p. 66.

Frivolous amusement, Bladder Tree.

Frugality, Succory, Endive, or Chiccory.

This plant is mentioned by Horace : —

“me pascunt olivæ,
Me cichorea, levesque malvæ.”

It is useful in medicine, being of cooling and antiscorbutic properties.



Genius, Plane, or Platane.

Giddiness, Almond Tree. See p. 19.

Glory, Laurel. See p. 81.

Good education, Cherry Tree.

Good fortune, Mugwort. See p. 47.

Goodness, Snowball, or Guelder Rose.

Grace, Birch.

Coleridge calls the birch the "lady of the woods;" and Gerald Massey writes, —

" Lady of the forest
Is the silver birk;
Shimmering in the sunshine,
Shivering at the mirk:
* * *
'Mid the dance of colors
And semitones of green,
Gleams this daintier spirit
That in leafdom is the queen."

A wine made from the juice of the birch was once highly esteemed. The fragrant Russia leather used in bookbinding is prepared with the empyreumatic oil of the birch.

Grandeur, Ash.

The miraculous tree Ygdrasil of the Edda, with its top reaching to heaven and its roots to hell, was an ash.

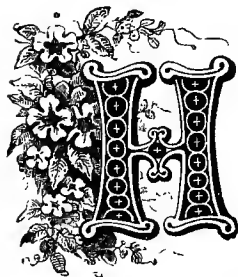
Gratitude, Camellia. Agrimony.

The camellia japonica, as its name shows, comes to us from Japan, and is the ornament of every garden in that country and in China. It well repays careful cultivation.

The name *camellia* is from George Camellus, a missionary, and author of a work on botany.

Agrimony has a bitter and slightly aromatic taste. Cattle dislike it, but it is thought to have some useful medicinal qualities.

Grief, Garden Marigold. See p. 56.



Happiness, Sweet Sultan.

A native of Turkey.

Hatred, Basil.

The Greek name of this herb signifies *royal*; but its identity with, or similarity to, that of a fabulous creature supposed to kill by a single glance, has caused basil to become the emblem of hate, hatred being said to have eyes like the basilisk. Poverty is sometimes figured as a woman covered with rags, seated beside a plant of basil.

Healing, Balm of Gilead.

The true balm of Gilead, produced by the *Amyris Gileadensis*, is never to be met with pure, except in the East; and therefore its place is usually supplied by the American balm of Gilead, which exudes from a beautiful species of fir, and resembles the Oriental balm in most of its essential qualities.

Heart left to desolation, Chrysanthemum.

The pretty flowers that enliven the autumn with their varied

hues ought surely to be emblems of some more cheerful sentiment than this. China is the native country of the chrysanthemum, as of many other of our most valued flowers, whence it was introduced into Europe in 1789. It is a favorite with gardeners throughout India, and very beautiful dwarf plants of it are reared for in-door decoration.

Hidden merit, *Coriander.*

The aromatic seeds of this plant are much used by confectioners and physicians; but the odor of fresh coriander is insufferable, as the name *koris* expresses.

Hope, *Hawthorn.* See p. 23.

Horror, *Serpent Cactus.*

Hospitality, *Oak.* See p. 73.

Humility, *Bindweed.*



I adore you, *Heliotrope.* See p. 62.

I am your captive, *Peach Blossom.*

I cling to thee, *Vetch*, or *Chick Pea*.

I die if neglected, *Laurestine*. See p. 80.

I feel your benefits, *Flax*.

Linen, lace, and paper remind us every instant of this useful plant. The seeds are used in preparing poultices, and also make a useful drink; while the oil expressed from them is invaluable to painters.

Illness, *Garden Anemone*.

In some provinces the anemone is thought to poison the air, and cause various maladies. Ovid makes the anemone spring from the blood of Adonis.

“ ‘Could Pluto’s queen with jealous fury storm,
And Meuthe to a fragrant herb transform?
Yet dares not Venus with a change surprise,
And in a flower bid her fallen hero rise?’
Then on the blood sweet nectar she bestows;
The scented blood in little bubbles rose,
Little as rainy drops which fluttering fly,
Borne by the winds along a lowering sky.
Short time ensued, till where the blood was shed
A flower began to rear its purple head;
Such as on Punic apples is revealed,
Or in the filmy rind but half concealed.
Still here the fate of lovely forms we see,
So sudden fades the sweet anemone.
The feeble stems to stormy blasts a prey,
Their sickly beauties droop and pine away;
The winds forbid the flowers to flourish long,
Which owe to winds their name in Grecian song.”
Tr. by Eusden.

Immortality, *Amaranth*. See p. 74.

Impatience, *Balsamine*.

The impatient seed-vessels of the balsamine burst open suddenly at the slightest touch.

Importunity, Burdock.

The burdock takes possession of good ground, from which it is very difficult to extirpate it. The attachment of the burrs to clothing is familiar to all. Unprepossessing as the burdock appears, it seems to be a useful plant. The roots and stalks are said to be eatable, either boiled or in salad. Snails feed on its rough leaves, which are also used as a poultice; and the seeds are recommended as good to fatten poultry.

Independence, Wild Plum.

This indocile tree dislikes to be pruned or transplanted.

Indifference, Candy Tuft.**I never trouble, Rose Leaf.**

The well-known reply of Dr. Zeb to the academicians of Amadan illustrates this sentiment.

Infidelity, Yellow Rose.**Injustice, Hop.****Innocence, Innocence, or Houstonia cærulea.**

“It comes when wakes the pleasant spring,
When first the earth is green;
Four white or pale blue leaves it hath,
With yellow heart between.

It grows about a heap of stones,
For there the dew will stay;
It springs beside the dusty road,
Where children are at play.

It dots with stars the grassy bank
That slopes adown the brook,
And there it takes a deeper blue,
And there a fresher look.

* * * *

We call thee Innocence, sweet one;
 And well it thee beseems,
 For thou art cherished in the heart,
 With childhood's sinless dreams."
Mrs. Seba Smith.

Inspiration, *Angelica*.

This beautiful plant, which grows in the remotest countries of the north, forms a crown for the Lapland poets, who believe that its sweet odor gives inspiration.

The *Flora Medica* says, "The leaf and seeds, when recent, and the root, both fresh and dried, are tonic and carminative, and may be considered the most elegant aromatic of our northern climes. By the Laplanders and Icelanders *angelica* is much in request, both as an article of food and for medicinal purposes. The former use it for many catarrhal and pectoral affections; the stalks, roasted, are used by them as an article of food; and we are told by Sir George Mackenzie, that the Icelanders eat the stems and roots raw with butter. In this country [England,] the tender stems are cut in May, and made into an agreeable sweetmeat. By Gerard *angelica* is extolled as a panacea for all the ills of life."

Intemperance, *Grape*.

Pliny mentions a vine six hundred years old.

The vine at Hampton Court, in the year 1816, produced a ton of grapes.

Intrinsic worth, *Gentian*.

The name is said to be derived from *Gentianus*, a king of Illyria. Some varieties of the gentian are used in medicine, the root being an excellent bitter. Bryant has sung the praises of the beautiful fringed gentian, and we quote

a sonnet, new, perhaps, to some of our readers, on this most lovely flower.

SONNET

TO THE FRINGED GENTIAN.

“ Oft had I heard thy beauty praised, dear flower,
 And often sought for thee through field and wood;
 Yet could I never find the secret bower
 Where thou dost lead, in maiden solitude,
 A cloistered life, until, this autumn day,
 Beside a tree that shook her golden hair
 And laughed at death, flaunting her rich array,
 I found thee, blue as the still depths of air
 Seen leagues away, between the pine-wood boughs.
 O, never yet a gladder sight hath met
 These eyes of mine! Depart, before the snows
 Of hastening winter thy fringed garments wet!
 Thine azure flowers should never fade nor die,
 But bloom, exhale, and gain their native sky.”

The New Path, Oct., 1865.

I prefer you, *Rose Geranium*.

Irony, *Sardonia*.

This plant, of the ranunculus family, has some resemblance to parsley. It contains a poison, which contracts the mouth so strangely, that the person appears to laugh while dying. Hence the expression, a *sardonic laugh*.

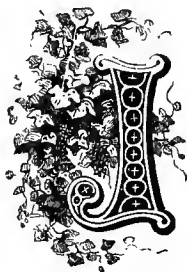
I shall not survive you, *Black Mulberry*.

The reader is referred to the history of Pyramus and Thisbe, in La Fontaine.

I share your feelings, *Double Daisy*. See p. 90.

I surmount everything, *Mistletoe*. See p. 78.

I will think of it, *Single Field Daisy*. See p. 88.



Joy, Wood Sorrel, or Oxalis.

Justice shall be done you, Fragrant Coltsfoot. See p. 70.



Keep your promises, Plum Tree.

This tree blossoms profusely every year ; but unless some of this useless ornament is removed, it bears fruit only every third year.



Lasting beauty, *Common Gillyflower.* See p. 54.

Levity, Lightness, *Larkspur.*

Life, *Lucern.*

Love, *Myrtle. Red Damask Rose.* See pp. 24, 36.

Luxury, *Horse-chestnut.* See p. 18.



Majesty, *White Lily.* See p. 53.

Maternal love, *Moss.* See p. 79.

Meanness. *Dodder.*

The seed of the dodder germinates in the ground; but as soon as its stem encounters that of another plant, it fastens itself to it; the root dries up, and it lives entirely at the expense of the other. Like a vile parasite, it absorbs all the juices of its supporter, and soon kills it.

Melancholy, *Weeping Willow. Dead Leaves.* See p. 18.

“The melancholy days are come,
The saddest of the year,
Of wailing winds, and naked woods,
And meadows brown and sere.
Heaped in the hollows of the grove,
The withered leaves lie dead;
They rustle to the eddying gust,
And to the rabbit's tread.”

Bryant.

A modern French poet, V. de Laprade, has also written a beautiful poem, beginning *Feuilles, tombez.*

Message, *Common Garden Iris.*

There are more than thirty varieties of the iris. Its varied and beautiful colors have caused it to be named from the lovely messenger of the gods. Orris root is the root of the Florentine iris. The Persian iris is very fragrant.

Misanthropy, *Teasel.*

Mistrust, *Lavender.*

It was formerly believed that asps had their lurking-places under lavender, and therefore this plant was approached with mistrust. Lavender is a grateful perfume, and a specific for headaches and nervousness.

Modest Worth, *Primrose*. See p. 24.

Modesty, *Blue Violet*. See p. 92.

Mourning, *Purple Scabious*, or *Mourning Bride*. *Cypress*. See p. 71.

Music, *Reeds*.

Pan formed the Arcadian pipe from the reeds into which Syrx was transformed.

My best days are past, *Meadow Saffron*. See p. 68.

My gratitude exceeds your cares, *Dahlia*. See p. 55.



Naïveté, *Silver Weed*.

Native grace, *Cowslip*.

Shakspeare makes the servant of the fairy queen say;—

“The cowslips tall her pensioners be;
 In their gold coats spots you see:
 Those be rubies, fairy favors;
 In those freckles live their savors:
 I must go seek some dew-drops here,
 And hang a pearl in every cowslip’s ear,

Neatness, *Broom*.

The broom is found wild in Europe. It is a fragrant, papilionaceous, yellow flower. Burns says in his *Caledonia*,—

“Their groves of sweet myrtle let foreign lands reckon,
Where bright beaming summers exalt the perfume;
Far dearer to me yon lone glen o’ green breckan,
Wi’ the burn stealing under the lang yellow broom.”

And Shakspeare mentions

“broom groves,
Whose shadow the dismissed bachelor loves,
Being lass-lorn.”

Novelty, *Dahlia*. See p. 55.



Obstacle, *Rest-harrow*. See p. 27.

Occupation, *Foxglove*.

Rhind says, “The beauty of this plant has recommended it to the notice of the florist, and it is accordingly often found in the garden parterre. It also forms an ornamental and conspicuous object in many woodland and mountain scenes in Scotland and Wales. Among the country people it has

received various names. In the south of Scotland it is still called 'bloody fingers;' in the north, 'dead man's bells.' In Wales it is called 'fairies' gloves.' Fairies were often called '*folks*;' hence, no doubt, the origin of the common name '*folk's glove*,' and not, as misspelled, *foxglove*." The foxglove has very powerful medicinal qualities, especially in dropsy, and to retard the circulation. It requires to be administered with great caution, being a violent poison. The Italians value it so highly that they have a proverb, "*Aralda tutte le piaghe sana*" (Foxglove cures all hurts). There are two kinds, the purple or red, and the white. A poet writes, —

" Here the spotted foxglove dwells,
 Ringing oft its fairy bells;
 And its sister, purely white,
 Makes the shady places bright,
 Like that maiden mild and young
 By Spenser's magic numbers sung."

Oracle, Dandelion.

The dandelion is used as a salad, as greens, as a bitter, and to prepare a kind of coffee. Its feathery seed-globes are made to give various prophecies; hence its meaning, *oracle*.

Ornament, Hornbeam.

Under the name of *charmille*, this fine tree was formerly the principal ornament of the great gardens of France; and one can still see at Versailles how the famous Le Nôtre employed it in his compositions. Father Rapin has eulogized it in verse.

Ostentation, Peony.

The peony was called from the Greek Pæon, who is said to have used it in medicine, and cured Pluto, by its means, of a

wound inflicted by Hercules. There are two kinds of the peony. The herbaceous one is found native in Europe and Asia; the shrubby one comes from China and Japan.



Painful recollections, *Flos Adonis.* See p. 52.

Patience, *Patience.*

A kind of dock.

Patriotism, *Nasturtium.*

Peace, *Olive.*

Neptune disputed with Minerva about naming the new city of Athens, and it was agreed that the one who gave the best gift to man should give the name. Neptune produced the horse, Minerva the olive tree, and she was victorious.

An English author says of the olive tree, "It has been compared to a willow; it differs, however, very materially

in its color, having none of that sickly hue of bluish green which gives such a peculiar coldness to the landscapes of some of the Dutch painters. The upper side of the leaf has precisely that tint familiarly known by the name of olive. The under side is of shining whiteness, and as the foliage is turned up by the lightest breeze, its progress over the valleys covered with olive gardens becomes visible in the form of a silver cloud gliding across the landscape. The inhabitants of the south of Europe employ the oil expressed from the fruit of this tree for the same purposes as we employ butter, and feel at least as much dislike to the produce of the dairy, as an article of food, as we may feel to the use of oil." Ruffini has set this last fact charmingly before his readers in the beautiful story of "Doctor Antonio."

Pensive beauty, *Laburnum*.

Pensiveness, *Cowslip*.

Perfect excellence, *Strawberry*. See p. 33.

Perpetual pleasure, *Everlasting Pea*.

Perseverance, *Magnolia*.

The *magnolia grandiflora* is the most superb vegetable production of the New World. Its region is from South Carolina to the Isthmus of Darien. We are also told that it is found in China. The peculiar and fascinating odor of the magnolia flower can never be forgotten if once inhaled.

Petulance, *Barberry*.

The flowers of this shrub are so irritable, that at the slightest touch the stamens contract around the pistil.

Platonic love, *Locust.* See p. 52.

Pleasantry, *Balm Mint, or Lemon Balm.*

An infusion of it tends to exhilarate.

Poetry, *Eglantine.* See p. 45.

Power, *Crown Imperial.*

Preference, *Apple Blossom.*

Presage, *Rainy Marigold.*

This flower, in dry weather, opens at seven and closes at four. If it does not open, or closes before its hour, it is considered a sure sign of rain.

Presumption, *Snapdragon.*

Pretension, *Willow Herb.*

This pretty plant seems to take delight in viewing itself in the water; like a pretentious woman enamoured of her own charms.

Pride, *Amaryllis.*

Gardeners call this beautiful plant proud, because it often refuses to flower under careful culture. The name of these plants is derived from a Greek verb signifying to shine.

Privation, *Indian Plum, or Myrobalan.*

The fruit has the color and look of a fine cherry, but contains only an insipid, sickening juice. Even the birds refuse to eat them.

Profit, *Cabbage.*

Prohibition, *Privet, or Prim.* See p. 31.

Promptness, *Stock Gillyflower*.

Prosperity, *Beech*.

Gilbert White calls the beech "the most lovely of all forest trees, whether we consider its smooth rind or bark, its glossy foliage, or graceful, pendulous boughs." Old Evelyn says, "They make spreading trees, and noble shades with their well-furnished and glistening leaves." And Miller writes, "Not that the color of the oak is to be compared to the rich orange hue of the beech, which is, beyond question, the most beautiful of all autumnal colors to an eye that loves a deep blaze." In the olden times, beds, light and fragrant, were made from beech leaves. The oil from beech nuts is said to be but little inferior to olive oil.

Prudence, *Service Tree. Lemon*. See p. 77.

The lemon tree is proverbial for its fertility. In 1812, a wager was laid between a gentleman of Massa and the Marchese Calani of Spezzia, that a lemon tree at Cresullo, half a mile from Massa, would produce fourteen thousand lemons. It exceeded that number.

Pure and deep love, *Carnation*. See p. 49.

Pure love, *Red Pink*.

Purity, *Star of Bethlehem. White Violet. White Lily*. See p. 53.

**Rarity, Mandrake.**

“ Not poppy, nor mandragora,
Nor all the drowsy sirups of the world
Shall ever medicine thee to that sweet sleep
Which thou ow'dst yesterday.”

Shakspeare.

The ancients attributed great virtues to the mandragora; but as they have left us no exact description of the plant, we are ignorant to what species they gave the name. Charlatans, by a gross artifice, sometimes make several roots assume the shape of a man, and tell the credulous that they are true mandrakes, found only in an almost inaccessible part of China. They are fabled to utter cries when pulled up, and the person who uproots them is supposed to die soon after. To procure this root, they say it should be carefully uncovered, and pulled up by means of a string attached to a dog, which then bears the penalty of the impious deed.

Reason, Goat's Rue.

This plant is thought useful in cases of disordered intellects.

Reconciliation, Hazel.

“ Ye swains, now hasten to the hazel bank,
 Where down yon dale the wildly winding brook
 Falls hoarse from steep to steep. In close array,
 Fit for the thickets and the tangling shrub,
 Ye virgins, come. For you their latest song
 The woodlands raise; the clustering nuts for you
 The lover finds amid the secret shade,
 And where they burnish on the topmost bough
 With active vigor crushes down the tree,
 Or shakes them ripe from the resigning husk.”

Thomson.

The hazel was said to have been imported into Italy from Pontus; hence the Roman name, *nux pontica*, which was changed later to *nux avellana*, from a Neapolitan city where it was cultivated. The filbert is not a distinct species, but a mere variety of hazel.

Gower tells us, —

“ Phillis
 Was shape into a nutte-tree,
 That all men it might see;
 And after Phillis, *Philberd*
 This tree was cleped.”

But Rhind says filbert is a corruption of *full-beard*, a word applied to designate the large, fringed husk. As the wood of the hazel is very flexible, it is applied to various uses. Of it are made hoops for barrels, hurdles, fishing-rods, crates, poles, and walking-sticks. In Italy the chips are used to clear turbid wine. Withering informs us that in some places the twigs take the place of yeast. Hazel charcoal is prized by artists, as it draws freely, and rubs out easily. The caduceus of Mercury was supposed to be a hazel wand, given him by Apollo.

Regret beyond the tomb, Asphodel.

The ancients planted this flower beside tombs, and believed

that beyond Acheron the spirits walked in a vast field of asphodel, drinking the water of Lethe.

Remembrance, Rosemary.

“There’s rosemary — that’s for remembrance; pray you,
love, remember.”

“For you, there’s rosemary and rue; these keep
Seeming and savor all the winter long;
Grace and remembrance be to you both.”

“Stick your rosemary
On this fair corse.”

Shakspeare.

Rosemary is used at christenings, weddings, and funerals. It blossoms about Christmas, and our ancestors used to stir up with a branch of rosemary the spiced Christmas tankard. Herrick, in allusion to its different uses, says that it

“Grows for two ends; it matters not at all
Be it for my bridal, or my burial.”

This aromatic plant has had a merited reputation, from the most ancient times, as a remedy in headaches and nervous disorders. It forms the principal ingredient in the celebrated *Eau de la Reine de Hongrie*, or Hungary Water.

Henry Kirke White wrote,—

TO THE HERB ROSEMARY.

“Sweet-scented flower! who ’rt wont to bloom
On January’s front severe,
And o’er the wintry desert drear
To waft thy waste perfume!
Come, thou shalt form my nosegay now,
And I will bind thee round my brow;
And as I twine the mournful wreath
I’ll weave a melancholy song;
And sweet the strain shall be and long,
The melody of death,

Come, funeral flower, who lov'st to dwell
 With the pale corse in lonely tomb,
 And throw'st across the desert gloom
 A sweet decaying smell, —
 Come, press my lips, and lie with me
 Beneath the lowly alder tree;
 And we will aleep a pleasant sleep,
 And not a care shall dare intrude
 To break the marble solitude,
 So peaceful and so deep."

Remorse, Raspberry.

Rendezvous, Pimpernel.

Its punctuality in opening and closing makes it a fit emblem for an appointment.

Repose, Buckbean. See p. 21.

Reserve, Maple.

The maple has been made the emblem of reserve, because its flowers are slow to open, and very long in falling.

Resistance, Tremella Nostoc, or Nostoc Commune.

Nothing positive is known about this gelatinous plant, which seems a link between the animal and vegetable kingdoms. It was celebrated among the alchemists, who thought it an emanation from the stars, and used it in searching after the philosopher's stone and the universal panacea.

Retirement, Harebell.

The Lady of the Lake says, as she plucks a harebell, —

" This little flower, that loves the lea,
 May well my simple emblem be;
 It drinks heaven's dew as blithe as rose
 That in the king's own garden grows;
 And when I place it in my hair,
 Allan, a hard is hound to swear
 He ne'er saw coronet so fair."

“Have ye ever heard, in the twilight dim,
 A low, soft strain,
 That ye fancied a distant vesper hymn,
 Borne o’er the plain
 By the zephyrs that rise on perfumed wing,
 When the sun’s last glances are glimmering?

* * * *

The source of that whispering strain I’ll tell;
 For I’ve listened oft
 To the music faint of the blue harebell,
 In the gloaming soft;
 ’Tis the gay fairy folk the peal who ring
 At eventime for their banqueting.

And gayly the trembling bells peal out
 With gentle tongue,
 While elves and fairies career about,
 ’Mild dance and song:
 O, roses and lilies are fair to see,
 But the wild bluebell is the flower for me.”

Wild Flowers.

Return of happiness, *Lily of the Valley.* See p. 30.

Reverie, *Osmunda.*

No one can form an adequate idea of the beauty of the *osmunda regalis*, according to Curtis, who has not seen this fern growing in the southern part of England, where, sheltered by alders, it grows to the height of five feet, bearing at the extremities a mass of fructification so conspicuous as to have caused it to be commonly known as *flowering fern*. Its virtues are highly extolled by ancient authors. “Osmonde,” says the translator of Dodonæus, “is hoate in the first degree, and dry in the second. The harte of the root of osmunde is good against squattes or bruises, heavie or greevous falles, and whatever hurt or dislocation soever it be.”

Riches, *Corn.*

Roughness, *Scratchweed.*

Rapture, *Greek Valerian*, or *Polemony*.

The name is from *Polemos*, which means war, because, as Pliny assures us, several kings disputed for the honor of having discovered it.



Sadness, *Yew*. See p. 88.

Sensibility, *Verbena*.

The original of all the numerous verbenas now cultivated was the *verbena melindres*, or common scarlet, carried from South America to England. These flowers are of such varied and beautiful tints, and so easy of cultivation, that we could ill spare them from the flower bed or window.

Sensitiveness, *Sensitive Plant*, or *Mimosa*.

Serenade, *Dew Plant*.

The resemblance to dew-drops of the little transparent vesicles in the leaves of this plant probably caused the connection of ideas with evening music.

Sighing, *Aspen*.

Silence, *White Rose*. See p. 43.

Silliness, *Scarlet Geranium*. See p. 70.

Simplicity, *Wild Single Rose*.

Sincerity, *Fern*.

Thomas Miller says, "The very name of the fern calls up the forest, where it still lives on, though ages ago the mighty oaks have been felled—there it still spreads, true to its native soil, the hardy image of deep-rooted sincerity. It is associated with our oldest fairy legends, and our simple ancestors believed that they had but to find the true fern seed, and carry it about with them, to become invisible."

Skill, *Spider Orchis*.

This flower resembles the insect into which Arachne was transformed by Minerva, and which, under its hideous form, has lost nothing of her skill.

Sleep, *White Poppy*.

The palace of Somnus was a cave near the Cimmerians. Poppies grew before the entrance, and Morpheus, his prime minister, watched over his couch, a vase in one hand and poppies in the other. The poets have drawn many fine similes from this flower, as for instance,—

"As full-blown poppies, overcharged with rain,
Decline the head, and, drooping, kiss the plain,
So sinks the youth."

Pope's Homer.

"But pleasures are like poppies spread;
Yon seize the flower, its bloom is shed."

Burns.

Solitude, *Heath*. See p. 31.

Sorcery, *Enchanted Nightshade*.

Sourness, *Barberry*.

Stoicism, *Box*.

Strength, *Fennel*.

The gladiators mixed it with their food to give them strength; and after the games of the arena, the victor was crowned with fennel.

Milton speaks of the "smell of sweetest fennel;" and Longfellow says, in the "Goblet of Life,"—

"Above the lowly plants it towers,
The fennel, with its yellow flowers;
And in an earlier age than ours
Was gifted with the wondrous powers
Lost vision to restore."

Superior merit, *Moss Rose*. See p. 44.

Surety, *Cistus*.

Aristotle assures us that this plant preserves those who hold it in their hands from spirits and phantoms.

Suspicion, *Mushroom*.

Some kinds of mushrooms are edible, and others, resembling them closely, are very poisonous.

Sweet disposition, *Lavatera*.

The lavatera is an extremely delicate and lovely garden mallow. It is called after the celebrated physiognomist Lavater.

Sweet memories, *Periwinkle*. See p. 20.

Sympathy, *Thrift*.



Taste, *Fuchsia*.

This graceful plant is a native of Mexico, and was named from L. Fuchs, a German botanist.

Tears, *Elecampane*, or *Helenium*.

It was fabled to have sprung from the tears of Helen.

Temptation, *Quince*.

The quince is found in a wild state in Austria. Pliny says it was brought into Italy from Cydon, in Crete; hence its botanical name, *malus cydonia*. It is also described under the names of *pyrus cydonia* and *cydonia vulgaris*. The far-famed apples of the Hesperides were most probably quinces. The French call the quince tree *coignassier*, because, according to Du Hamel, the unpleasant odor of the fruit caused it to be planted in a remote corner (*coin*) of the orchard or garden. In New England, the smell is generally considered rather pleasant than otherwise. In the south of France, the marmalade called *cotignac* is prepared from this fruit. The word



Lith. à la Vapeur de Unyay Parang. In Deur : Paris

PUBLISHED BY DE VRIES, IBARRA ET C^o, BOSTON.

marmalade is said to come from the Portuguese name of the quince, *marmelo*. The seeds are used for jelly, bandoline, and mucilage, though these last preparations do not keep long.

Quince pie was anciently esteemed a delicacy. In *Romeo and Juliet*, the nurse tells Lady Capulet, —

“ They call for dates and quinces in the pastry.”

The Graces, *Hundred-Leaved Rose*.

When the Graces attend the Muses, they wear wreaths of this rose.

Thought, *Pansy*.

“ And there is pansies; that's for thoughts.”

Shakspeare.

“ Lilies for a bridal bed,
Roses for a matron's head,
Violets for a maiden dead;
Pansies let my flowers be.”

Shelley.

There is no end of fanciful names for this flower, such as, three faces under a hood, heart's-ease, kiss-me-quick, ladies'-delight, love-in-idleness, and, among the Germans, little step-mother. Shakspeare's famous compliment to Queen Elizabeth gives us its origin: —

“ That very time I saw (but thou couldst not),
Flying between the cold moon and the earth,
Cupid all armed: a certain aim he took
At a fair vestal, throned by the west,
And loosed his love-shaft smartly from his bow,
As it should pierce a hundred thousand hearts.
But I might see young Cupid's fiery shaft
Quenched in the chaste beams of the watery moon;
And the imperial votaress passed on,
In maiden meditation, fancy free,
Yet marked I where the bolt of Cupid fell.
It fell upon a little western flower,
Before, milk-white; now, purple with love's wound,
And mensidens call it love-in-idleness.”

Time, *White Poplar*.

This was made the emblem of time, because its leaves, dark on one side and bright on the other, represent day and night.

Timidity, *Four o'Clock*, or *Marvel of Peru*. See p. 69.

Tranquillity, *Gold Basket*.

This plant has been supposed to have the power of curing madness.

Treachery, *Whortleberry*, or *Huckleberry*. *Monkshood*, or *Aconite*.

Ænomaüs, father of the fair Hippodamia, had for a groom Myrtilus, the son of Mercury. Proud of this advantage, he required all the pretenders to his daughter's hand to compete with him in a chariot race. Pelops, who wished to obtain Hippodamia, promised Myrtilus a great reward if he would take out the pin which held his master's chariot wheels. He did so; the car was upset, and Ænomaüs was killed; but, expiring, he besought Pelops to avenge him, which he did by throwing Myrtilus into the sea. Thrown back on the shore, Mercury changed him to this shrub, which resembles a little myrtle. Its pretty, bell-shaped flowers are succeeded by dark berries of an agreeable flavor.

Professor Burnett says of aconite, "Its deleterious effects were well known to the ancients, who regarded it as the most violent of all poisons, — being unacquainted with those of mineral origin, — and fabled it to be the invention of Hecate, who caused it to spring from the foam of Cerberus. Aconite is said to have been the principal ingredient in the poisonous cup that was mingled by Medea for Theseus; and it was the

poison employed to execute the barbarous law in the island of Ceos, which condemned to death all who were no longer useful to the state." It is now used as a powerful remedy in gout, rheumatism, paralysis, and intermittent fevers.

Truth, *Bittersweet*, or *Woody Nightshade*.



Uncertainty, *Mock Orange*.

Unchanging friendship, *Arbor Vitæ*.

United hearts, *Phlox*.

Uselessness, *Queen of the Meadow*, *Meadow Sweet*, or *Spiræa*.

Uselessness is the universal signification of this pretty flower; but Mr. Miller well suggests that it be changed to Neglected Beauty.

Utility, *Grass*. See p. 17.



Vain-glory, *Hydrangea*, or *Hortensia*.

A shrub from the East Indies, whose showy corymbs of changeable flowers, and handsome green leaves, formerly made it a great favorite.

Vain is beauty without merit, *Cockle*, and *Rose Champion*.

Pretty, but scentless flowers, growing in or near corn-fields. We read in Job xxxi. 40, "Let thistles grow instead of wheat, and cockle instead of barley."

Variety, *Double German Aster*. See p. 61.

Vice, *Tares*. See p. 51.

Victory, *Laurel*. See p. 81.

Voluptuousness, *Tuberose*. *Moss Rose*. See pp. 61, 44.



War, *Milfoil, or Yarrow.*

Achilles, whose name this plant bears in botany, used it to heal the wounds of Telephus.

Warmth of feeling, *Peppermint.*

Proserpina surprised Menthe in the arms of Pluto, and, justly irritated, changed her to a plant, whose double savor seems to contain the chill of fear and the warmth of love.

Weakness, *Musk Plant.*

Wealth, *Wheat.* See p. 55.

Welcome, *Trailing Arbutus, Mayflower, or Ground Laurel.*

“Art thou not dearer in Spring’s first prime
Than the fairest rose of the Summer time?”

“A charm hast thou no forest flower can boast,
Thou little beaming herald of the Spring!
How thrilled thy smile when on our rock-bound coast
The wearied pilgrims found thee blossoming!

* * * *

A blessing on thy graceful, perfumed bell,
That bloomed in roseate tints for years unknown,
And peered above the withered leaves to tell
How in the wilderness God's love is shown."

H. N. Jenks.

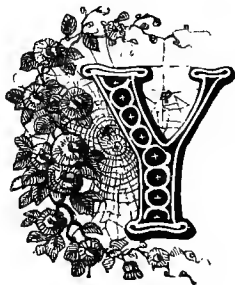
Wisdom, *White Mulberry*.

Without pretension, *Cinnamon Rose*.

There is a peculiar look of incompleteness and want of finish about this rose. Its color is very dull, compared with the rest of its glowing sisterhood, and the bush has an irregular, ragged growth. Yet it is often quite fragrant, and the leaf is sometimes very pretty. It should always be gathered in bud.

Words, though sweet, may deceive, *American Laurel*.

The great beauty of this shrub does not prevent farmers from exterminating it on their lands, because it is so poisonous to their sheep.



You are perfect, *Pine-Apple*.

This fragrant fruit was introduced into Holland, from South

America, about the middle of the seventeenth century; and the Earl of Portland carried it to England in 1690.

Thomson thus apostrophizes it:—

“Thou, the pride
Of vegetable life, beyond whate’er
The poets imaged in the golden age,—
Quick, let me strip thee of thy tufty coat,
Spread thy ambrosial stores, and feast with Jove.”

You are radiant with charms, *Garden Ranunculus.*

Your beauty is vain, *Hibiscus.*

“I would be fair, but see the fair and proud,
Like the bright sun, oft setting in a cloud.”
Wotton.

“Only a sweet and virtuous soul,
Like seasoned timber, never gives,
But, when the whole world turns to eal,
Then chiefly lives.”
Herbert.

“The body subject is
To fickle Fortune’s power,
And to a million of mishaps
Is easual every hour;
And death in time doth change
It to a elod of clay;
Whereas the mind, which is divine,
Runs never to decay.”
Lord Vaux.

The African hibiscus is a well-known annual in the flower garden, and those who have ever seen in some conservatory the superb variety *rosa sinensis*, or Chinese hibiscus, will not be likely to forget its exquisite richness of color. The Chinese are said to use the petals for blacking shoes.

Your charms are graven in my heart, *Spindle Tree.*

The spindle tree makes pretty hedges. Its wood is used for spindles and pencils. Sculptors and turners also prize it.

Your looks freeze me, *Ice Plant.*

Your presence revives me, *Rosemary.*

The Hungary Water, so refreshing a toilet article, is made from rosemary.

Your qualities surpass your charms, *Mignonette.* See p. 58.

Youth, *White Lilac.*

By its purity and short duration, this flower typifies youth.

Youthfulness, *Crocus.*

“The spendthrift crocus, bursting from the mould,
Naked and shivering, with his cup of gold.”

Holmes.





DICTIONARY
FOR
TRANSLATING A BOUQUET



Acacia (Common), . . .	<i>v.</i> Locust.
Acacia (Rose), . . .	Elegance.
Acanthus, . . .	Art.
Adonis (Flos), . . .	Painful recollections.
Agnus Castus, . . .	Coldness; life without love.
Agrimony, . . .	Gratitude.
Almond, . . .	Giddiness; heedlessness.

Aloe,	Bitterness.
Amaranth,	Immortality.
Amaryllis,	Pride.
Anemone (Garden),	Illness.
Anemone (Windflower), . . .	Desertion.
Angelica,	Inspiration.
Apple Blossom,	Preference.
Arbor Vitæ,	Unchanging friendship.
Ash,	Grandeur.
Aspen,	Sighing.
Asphodel,	Regret beyond the tomb.
Aster (Double German), . . .	Variety.
Aster (Large-flowered), . . .	Afterthought.



Bachelor's Button,	v. Bluebottle.
Balm Mint,	Pleasantry.
Balm of Gilead,	Healing.
Balsamine,	Impatience.
Barberry,	Petulance ; sourness.
Basil,	Hatred.
Bay,	v. Laurel.
Beech,	Prosperity.
Bee Orchis,	v. Orchis.
Bindweed,	Humility.
Birch,	Grace.

Bittersweet Nightshade, . . .	Truth.
Black Bryony, v.	Bryony.
Black Mulberry, v.	Mulberry.
Black Poplar, v.	Poplar.
Blackthorn, or Sloe, . . .	Difficulties.
Bladder Tree,	Frivolous amusement.
Bluebottle,	Delicacy.
Blue Passion Flower, . . v.	Passion Flower.
Blue Violet, v.	Violet.
Borage,	Abruptness.
Box,	Stoicism.
Briers,	Envy.
Brompton Stock, v.	Gillyflower.
Broom,	Neatness.
Bryony (Black),	Be my support.
Buckbean,	Calmness ; repose.
Bugloss,	Falsehood.
Burdock,	Importunity.
Buttercup, v.	Crowfoot.



Cabbage,	Profit.
Calla,	Feminine delicacy.
Camellia,	Gratitude.
Camomile,	Energy in adversity.
Candytuft,	Indifference.

Canterbury Bell,		Constancy.
Cardinal Flower,		Distinction.
Carnation,		Pure and deep love.
Celery Crowfoot,		<i>v.</i> Crowfoot.
Cherry,		A good education.
Chestnut,		Do me justice.
Chicory,		Frugality.
Chickpea,		<i>v.</i> Vetch.
Chickweed (Red),		<i>v.</i> Pimpernel.
Chrysanthemum,		A heart left to desolation.
Cinnamon Tree,		Forgiveness of injuries.
Cinquefoil,		A beloved daughter.
Circe,		<i>v.</i> Nightshade.
Cistus,		Surety.
Clematis,		Artifice.
Cockle,		Vain is beauty without merit.
Coltsfoot,		Justice shall be done you.
Columbine,		Folly.
Coreopsis,		Always cheerful.
Coriander,		Hidden merit.
Corn,		Riches.
Corn Flower,		<i>v.</i> Bluebottle.
Corn Poppy,		<i>v.</i> Poppy.
Cornelian Cherry,		Continuance ; duration.
Cowslip,		Native grace ; pensiveness.
Crocus,		Youthfulness.
Crowfoot,		Ingratitude.
Crown Imperial,		Power.
Cypress,		Mourning.



Dahlia,	{ My gratitude exceeds your cares novelty.
Daisy (Garden),	I share your feelings.
Daisy (Single Field),	I will think of it.
Dandelion,	Oracle.
Datura,	Deceitful charms.
Dew Plant,	Serenade.
Dittany of Crete,	Birth.
Dodder,	Meanness.



Ebony Tree,	Blackness.
Eglantine,	Poetry.
Elder,	Compassion.
Elecampane,	Tears.
Enchanter's Nightshade,	v. Nightshade.
Everlasting,	Always remembered.
Everlasting Pea,	Perpetual pleasure.



Fennel,	Force ; strength.
Fern,	Sincerity.
Filbert,	<i>v.</i> Hazel.
Fir,	Elevation.
Flax,	I feel your benefits.
Flos Adonis,	Painful recollections.
Forget-me-not,	Forget me not.
Four o'Clock,	<i>v.</i> Marvel of Peru.
Foxglove,	Occupation.
Fraxinella,	Fire.
Fuchsia,	Taste ; fragility.



Gentian,	Intrinsic worth.
Geranium (Oak),	A melancholy mind.
Geranium (Rose),	I prefer you.
Geranium (Scarlet),	Silliness.
Gillyflower (Common),	Lasting beauty.
Gillyflower (Stock),	Promptness.
Goats' Rue,	Reason.

Gold Basket,	Tranquillity.
Grape Vine,	Intemperance.
Grass,	Utility.
Greek Valerian,	Rupture.
Golden Rod,	Encouragement.
Gorse, or Furze,	Anger.



Harebell,	Retirement.
Hawthorn,	Hope.
Hazel,	Reconciliation
Heart's-ease,	<i>v.</i> Pansy.
Heath,	Solitude.
Heliotrope,	Intoxication ; I adore you.
Henbane,	Blemish ; fault.
Hibiscus,	Beauty is vain.
Holly,	Foresight.
Hollyhock,	Fecundity ; ambition.
Honesty,	<i>æ.</i> Satin Flower.
Honeysuckle,	Bonds of love.
Hop,	Injustice.
Hornbeam,	Ornament.
Horse-chestnut,	Luxury.
Houstonia,	<i>v.</i> Innocence.
Hyacinth,	Benevolence.
Hydrangea,	Vain-glory ; heartlessness.



Ice Plant,	Your looks freeze me.
Indian Plum,	Privation.
Innocence,	Innocence.
Iris (Common Garden), . .	Message.
Iris (German),	Flame.
Ivy,	Friendship.



Jasmine (White),	Amiability.
Jonquil,	Desire.
Juniper,	Asylum ; aid.



Laburnum,	Pensive beauty.
Larch,	Boldness ; audacity.
Larkspur,	Lightness ; levity.

Laurel (American),	{ Words, though sweet, may de-
	ceive.
Laurel,	Glory ; victory.
Laurestine,	I die if neglected.
Lavatera,	Sweet disposition.
Lavender,	Mistrust.
Lemon,	Prudence.
Lettuce,	Coolness.
Lilac (Purple),	First emotion of love.
Lilac (White),	Youth.
Lily (Water),	Eloquence.
Lily (White),	Majesty ; purity.
Lily of the Valley,	Return of happiness.
Linden, or Lime,	Conjugal love.
Liverwort,	Confidence.
Locust,	Platonic love.
Lucern,	Life.
Lupine,	Dejection.



Madder,	Calumny.
Magnolia,	Perseverance.
Maiden Hair,	Discretion.
Manchineel Tree,	Falseness.
Mandrake,	Rarity.
Maple,	Reserve.

Marigold (Garden), . . .	Grief; chagrin.
Marigold (Rainy), . . .	A storm.
Marigold and Cypress, .	Despair.
Marshmallow, . . .	Beneficence.
Marvel of Peru, . . .	Timidity.
Mayflower, . . .	Welcome.
Meadow Saffron, . . .	My best days are past.
Mezereon, . . .	Desire to please. [charms.
Mignonette, . . .	Your qualities surpass your
Milfoil, . . .	War.
Milkweed, . . .	Hope in misery.
Mistletoe, . . .	I surmount everything.
Mock Orange, . . .	Uncertainty.
Monkshood, . . .	Treachery.
Morning Glory, . . .	Coquetry.
Moss, . . .	Maternal love.
Mugwort, . . .	Good luck; happiness.
Mulberry (Black), . . .	I shall not survive you.
Mulberry (White), . . .	Wisdom.
Mushroom, . . .	Suspicion.
Musk Plant, . . .	Weakness.
Myrtle, . . .	Love.



Narcissus, . . .	Egotism.
Nasturtium, . . .	Patriotism.

Nettle, Cruelty.
 Nightshade (Enchanter's), Sorcery.



Oak, Hospitality.
 Oleander, Beware.
 Olive, Peace.
 Orange Flower, Chastity.
 Orchis (Bee), Error.
 Orchis (Spider), Skill.
 Osier, Frankness.
 Osmunda, Reverie.
 Oxalis, v. Wood sorrel.



Pansy, Thought.
 Parsley, Festivity.
 Passion Flower, Devotion ; faith.
 Patience, Patience.
 Peach Blossom, I am your captive.
 Peony, Ostentation.

Peppermint,		Warmth of feeling.
Periwinkle,		Sweet memories.
Phlox,		Our hearts are united.
Pimpernel,		Rendezvous ; change.
Pine,		Endurance.
Pine-apple,		You are perfect.
Pink (Red),		Pure love.
Plane, or Platane,		Genius.
Plum,		Keep your promises.
Plum (Indian),		<i>v.</i> Indian Plum.
Plum (Wild),		Independence.
Polemony (Blue),		<i>v.</i> Greek Valerian.
Pomegranate,		Conceit.
Pompion, or Pumpkin,		Grossness ; coarseness.
Poplar (Black),		Courage.
Poplar (White),		Time.
Poppy (Corn),		Consolation.
Poppy (White),		Sleep.
Potato,		Benevolence.
Primrose,		Modest worth.
Privet, or Prim,		Prohibition.
Purple Scabious,		Mourning.



Queen of the Meadow,		Uselessness.
Quince,		Temptation.



Printé à la Vapeur de papier Japon, du Dessin de Paris

PUBLISHED BY DE VRIES, IBARRA ET C^o, BOSTON.



Ranunculus (Garden), . . .	You are radiant with charms.
Reeds,	Music.
Rest-harrow,	Obstacle.
Rhododendron,	Agitation.
Rose Acacia,	<i>v.</i> Acacia.
Rosebud,	Confession of love.
Rose (Cinnamon),	Without pretension.
Rose (Guelder),	<i>v.</i> Snowball.
Rose (Hundred-leaved), . . .	The Graces.
Rose Leaf,	I never trouble.
Rose (Monthly),	Beauty ever new.
Rose (Moss),	Superior merit ; voluptuousness.
Rose (Musk),	Capricious beauty.
Rose (Red Damask),	Love.
Rose (White),	Silence.
Rose (Wild Single),	Simplicity.
Rose (Yellow),	Infidelity.
Rosemary,	{ Remembrance ; your presence revives me.
Rue,	Disdain.
Rush,	Docility.



Saffron Crocus,	Do not abuse me.	
Sage,	Esteem.	
Saint John's Wort,	Animosity.	
Sardonia,	Irony.	
Satin Flower,	Forgetfulness.	
Scratchweed,	Roughness.	
Sensitive Plant,	Sensitiveness ; modesty.	
Serpent Cactus,	Horror.	
Service Tree, or Sorb,	Prudence.	
Silverweed,	Naïveté.	
Snapdragon,	Presumption.	
Snowball,	Goodness.	[sity.
Snowdrop,	Consolation ; a friend in adver-	
Speedwell,	Fidelity.	
Spider Orchis,	<i>v.</i> Orchis.	[heart.
Spindle Tree,	Your charms are graven on my	
Spiræa,	<i>v.</i> Queen of the Meadow.	
Star of Bethlehem,	Purity.	
Stock,	<i>v.</i> Gillyflower.	
Strawberry,	Perfect excellence.	
Succory,	<i>v.</i> Chicory.	
Sumach,	Splendid misery.	
Sunflower,	False riches.	
Sweet Basil,	<i>v.</i> Basil.	

Sweet Brier,	<i>v.</i> Eglantine.
Sweet Pea,	Departure.
Sweet Sultan,	Happiness.
Sweet William,	Finesse.
Syringa,	Fraternal love.



Tare,	Vice.
Teasel,	Misanthropy.
Thistle,	Austerity.
Thorn Apple,	Disguise.
Thrift,	Sympathy.
Thyme,	Activity.
Trailing Arbutus,	<i>v.</i> Mayflower.
Tremella,	Resistance.
Tuberose,	Voluptuousness.
Tulip,	Declaration of love.



Valerian (Common),	Accommodating disposition.
Valerian (Red),	Facility.

Venus's Looking-glass, . . .	Flattery.
Verbena,	Sensibility.
Veronica,	<i>v.</i> Speedwell.
Vervain,	Enchantment.
Vetch,	I cling to thee.
Vine,	<i>v.</i> Grape Vine.
Violet (Blue),	Modesty.
Violet (White),	Purity ; candor.
Virgin's Bower,	<i>v.</i> Clematis.



Wall Flower,	Fidelity in misfortune.
Water Lily,	<i>v.</i> Lily.
Weeping Willow,	Melancholy.
Wheat,	Wealth.
White Lily,	<i>v.</i> Lily.
White Mulberry,	<i>v.</i> Mulberry.
White Poplar,	<i>v.</i> Poplar.
White Poppy,	<i>v.</i> Poppy.
White Rose,	<i>v.</i> Rose.
White Violet,	<i>v.</i> Violet.
Whortleberry,	Treachery.
Wild Plum,	<i>v.</i> Plum.
Wild Rose,	<i>v.</i> Rose.
Willow (Basket),	<i>v.</i> Osier.
Willow (Common),	Forsaken.

Willow Herb,		Pretension.
Windflower,		v. Anemone.
Wood Sorrel,		Joy.
Wormwood,		Absence.



Yarrow,		v. Milfoil.
Yew,		Sadness.
Yoke Elm,		v. Hornbeam.



Zinnia,		I mourn your absence.
---------	-----------	-----------------------

“ I must fill up this osier cage of ours
With baleful weeds and precious juicéd flowers.

* * * *

Many for many virtues excellent,
None but for some, and yet all different.”

Shakspeare.

“ Flowers fresh in hue and many in their class,
Implore the pausing step, and with their dyes
Dance in the soft breeze in a fairy mass.”

Byron.